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SEPTEMBER 2026 CURRENT AFFAIRS

Banking & Financial Awareness



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September 2026 Banking & Financial Current Affairs
Key One-Liners

A. RBI, Regulation and Monetary Policy

1. **Policy rates snapshot:** Repo rate stands at **5.25%** (kept unchanged by the MPC), with **SDF/Reverse Repo 3.35%**, **MSF and Bank Rate 5.50%**, **CRR 3%** and **SLR 18%**.
2. **Basel III market risk:** RBI notified the *Commercial Banks – Minimum Capital Requirements for Market Risk Directions, 2026*, aligning with the revised **Basel III** framework; they apply from **1 April 2027**.
3. Under these directions, the **trading book** is now identified through the **Held for Trading (HFT)** sub-classification, and interest rate specific-risk tables follow **BCBS** norms; positions hedged by **total return swaps** are newly covered.
4. **InvIT/REIT valuation:** RBI standardised valuation of InvIT and REIT units held by **All-India Financial Institutions (AIFIs)** via new **Paragraphs 58A (InvITs) and 58B (REITs)**, issued under **Section 45L of the RBI Act, 1934**.
5. Unquoted InvIT/REIT units will be valued at their disclosed **NAV**; if NAV is not disclosed as per SEBI rules, or units are infrequently traded, they will be carried at a token **Rs 1**.
6. **Mule accounts:** RBI's draft framework lets banks freeze **only the disputed amount** (not the whole account) for suspicious transfers of **Rs 1,000 or more**, using **AI-based transaction monitoring**; it takes effect from **1 April 2027**.
7. In the mule framework, customers get **20 days** to justify a flagged transaction, banks get **10 days** to assess it, and police get **30 days** after referral via the **NCRP/CFCFRMS portal** to issue a restraint order; it follows a **Supreme Court** order of 4 August 2026.
8. The **Bankers' Books Evidence Act, 2026** comes into force on **1 October 2026**, recognising banking records in physical, electronic, digital and **cloud-based** forms on a **technology-neutral** basis.
9. **FCNR(B) swap window:** RBI's concessional USD–INR swap facility, opened on **8 June 2026**, drew **$143.6 billion** by 18 September, of which **FCNR(B) deposits were about $133 billion**, OFCBs **$5.32 billion** and ECBs **$5.3 billion**.
10. RBI shut the fresh FCNR(B) window on **31 August**, a month before the original **30 September** deadline; the **ECB and OFCB** swap windows stay open till **31 December 2026**.

11. The 2026 FCNR(B) haul is several times the roughly **$26 billion** raised under the similar **2013 scheme**; deposits were in the **3–5 year** maturity bucket.
12. The FCNR(B) flood pushed **bank deposit growth to 17.8%** (highest since **2011**), cut the **incremental credit-deposit ratio to 62.56%**, and narrowed the credit-deposit growth gap to **130 bps**; credit growth stood at **19.1%**.
13. RBI's **forex forward book** hit a record **$136.7 billion** in July 2026, driven by the swap-linked dollar inflows.
14. **Penalties:** RBI fined **Asset Care & Reconstruction Enterprise Rs 27.30 lakh** (management fees, under **SARFAESI Act, 2002**) and **Hero Fincorp Rs 10 lakh** (Fair Practices Code – interest charging).
15. RBI also fined **Ola Financial Services Rs 3.10 lakh** for **KYC** lapses under the **Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007**, and **KLM Axiva Finvest Rs 2.70 lakh** for violating **auction** procedure norms.
16. RBI **cancelled the registration of 5 NBFCs**, while **8 NBFCs surrendered** licences; Anagram Industries exited as an **unregistered CIC** and CDN Finance as an unregistered **Type I NBFC**.
17. **Payment aggregator licences: RNFI Services** got in-principle nod as **PA-Physical**, **Pluxee India** got **PA-Online and PA-Physical**, and **Jio Payment Solutions** got **PA-Cross Border** authorisation.
18. **Suman Ray** became **RBI Executive Director** from 1 September 2026 and will oversee **DICGC** and the **Premises Department**; he was earlier Regional Director, **Maharashtra**.
19. RBI allowed **LIC** to raise its stake in **ICICI Bank up to 9.99%** within one year; LIC held **4.35%** as of 30 June 2026.
20. At GFF 2026, **RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra** called fintech a bridge to formal finance, highlighting **UPI**, the **JAM trinity**, the **Unified Lending Interface (ULI)** and the **Regulatory Sandbox**.

B. Banks, UPI, Payments and Fintech

21. The **7th Global Fintech Fest (GFF) 2026** was held on **9–11 September** at **Jio World Centre, Mumbai**, organised by **PCI, NPCI and FCC**, on the theme *"Potential to Impact: Agentic AI · Tokenisation · Quantum"*.
22. At GFF 2026, **DFS** allowed **KCC and PM MUDRA** borrowers to spend their sanctioned credit limits directly at merchants through **UPI**.
23. **Maharashtra** unveiled its plan to become India's **first 'tokenised state'**; UPI now runs in **11 countries**.

24. **UPI tap-to-pay** at PoS terminals uses **NFC** technology; payments up to **Rs 5,000** need no UPI PIN, and support for **RuPay credit card on UPI** is included.
25. A UPI customer-support tool built on the small language model **FiMI (Finance Model for India)** was also launched.
26. **NPCI** introduced a **0.4% MDR** on **P2M UPI payments above Rs 2,000** from **15 October 2026**, ending the **zero-MDR regime** that began in **January 2020**.
27. Under the new UPI MDR, purchases of **Rs 75,000+** are capped at **Rs 300**; railways, telecom, insurance and fuel pay a flat **Rs 5**; capital-market payments attract **0.02% (cap Rs 300)**.
28. The 40 bps MDR is shared as **issuer bank 40%, acquirer 30%, UPI app 20%, partner bank 10%**; small merchants receiving up to **Rs 1 lakh/month** via QR stay **exempt**, and P2P and sub-Rs 2,000 payments stay free.
29. NPCI estimates UPI's annual running cost at about **Rs 20,000 crore**; the framework was finalised by the **UPI and Services Steering Committee**.
30. For capital-market payments, UPI limits are **Rs 5 lakh per transaction** and **Rs 10 lakh per day**; NPCI's **Bharat Connect** is building **Netbanking 2.0**.
31. **UPI** hit a record **24.51 billion transactions worth Rs 29.82 trillion** in **August 2026**, up **22% in volume** year-on-year, with **791 million** daily transactions.
32. **IMPS** volume dipped about **1% to 360 million** transactions (**Rs 7.04 trillion**) in August 2026.
33. **NPCI** launched two agentic AI platforms at GFF: **AiNxt** (a **Bring-Your-Own-Model** agent builder) and **AtOM – Agentic Orchestration & Messaging**, built on **JSON-RPC 2.0**.
34. **UIDAI** launched the **Face Auth SDK & Sandbox** at GFF 2026 to help developers integrate **Aadhaar face authentication**.
35. **PhonePe and Visa** partnered for cardless **Tap to Pay, Cross Border Scan to Pay and Smart Accept**, building on **Visa Device Tokenisation**.
36. **Axis Bank** became the **first Indian bank to offer Apple Pay** to its Visa and Mastercard credit card holders, secured by **tokenisation**.
37. Axis Bank's **Sparsh Week 2026** (7–11 September) ran on the theme **"Act with Speed"**, offering paperless auto and two-wheeler loans in **30 minutes**; MD & CEO is **Amitabh Chaudhry**.
38. **SBI** is targeting the **Rs 2.4 lakh crore wealth management** market; its wealth clients rose from **3.6 lakh to 4.64 lakh** in three years (Chairman: **C.S. Setty**).

39. **SBI** launched a digital **Savings-to-Salary Account** switch with fintech **ScoreMe Solutions** at GFF 2026; the switch is **customer-initiated**, not automatic.
40. **India Post Payments Bank** marked its **9th Foundation Day**, launching **DakPay Sound Box**, a **Digital Insurance Technology Platform** and a **Digital Mutual Fund Platform**.
41. IPPB had **13.25 crore customers** (77% rural, 49% women) as of March 2026; its **Surakshit Savings Account** carries **Rs 25,000 cyber-insurance**. IPPB was launched on **1 September 2018** under the **Department of Posts**.
42. **ICICI Bank** raised about **$17.9 billion** and **Yes Bank** about **$2 billion** through FCNR(B) deposits under RBI's swap window; SBI beat its **$10 billion** target.
43. **Bank of Baroda** (MD & CEO **Debadatta Chand**) crossed **$1 billion** in debt raised via the concessional window, including a **$400 million** reissue of its **August 2031** dollar bonds.
44. **Indian Bank** will open a **representative office in Dubai** and add **100 branches** this year; it absorbed **Allahabad Bank** in 2020.
45. **Canara Bank** reportedly committed over **Rs 50 crore** to comply with the **Digital Personal Data Protection Act (DPDPA)**.
46. **novio (Credilio)** and **Indian Overseas Bank** launched a co-branded **RuPay credit card** in **Select** and **Platinum** variants for UPI-active users.
47. **Kissht**, an RBI-registered NBFC, signed **Sachin Tendulkar** for its **'Loans Without Any Hiccups'** campaign; **PB Pay** (PB Fintech's payment aggregator, licensed **Feb 2026**) went live.

C. Economy, Markets, Ratings and Insurance

48. India's **GDP grew 7.8%** in **Q1 FY27** (April–June 2026), beating RBI's **7%** projection; the **IMF** (spokesperson **Julie Kozak**) called India a **key engine of global growth**.
49. **FY27 growth forecasts raised: OECD 7.1%** (up 80 bps; FY28 at 6.5%), **S&P 7%** (from 6.6%) and **Fitch 6.9%** (from 6.4%); Moody's also projects **7%.**
50. **Fitch and S&P** both expect RBI to **hike the repo rate by 25 bps**, with Fitch seeing it at **5.5%** in October; S&P sees CPI inflation averaging **5.1%** in FY27.
51. **Japan Credit Rating Agency (JCR)** upgraded India's sovereign rating from **BBB+ to A-** with a **Stable** outlook and lifted the country ceiling to **A**; it noted the fiscal deficit fell from **4.7% (FY25) to 4.4% (FY26)**.
52. **HSBC India Manufacturing PMI** slid to **52.8** in August 2026, its **lowest since August 2021** and below the long-run average of **54.2**.

53. **WPI inflation** rose to **9.92%** in August 2026, with **fuel and power** at **22.93%** and manufactured items at a series high of **8.37%**; the MPC has projected FY27 CPI at **5%**.
54. **Private corporate capex** rose **7% to Rs 30.3 trillion** in FY25, while total **GFCF** stood at **Rs 99.76 trillion**.
55. **NSO (MoSPI)** released the **first-ever district-level estimates** of the unincorporated non-farm sector based on **ASUSE 2025**, covering **757 of 770 districts**; national average **GVA per worker is Rs 1,56,539**.
56. **S&P** assigned **Bank of India** a **'BBB' long-term** and **'A-2' short-term** rating, citing capital, funding and likely government support.
57. **Jio Platforms** got **SEBI** approval for a **Rs 37,700 crore IPO**, set to beat **Hyundai Motor India's Rs 27,859 crore** as India's largest; **Kotak Mahindra Capital** is lead manager and approval is valid for **12 months**.
58. **SEBI** proposed changes to expiry-day derivatives settlement and the **Closing Auction Session (CAS)** (live since **3 August 2026**), including stopping the **Indicative Index Value (IIV)** display.
59. **SEBI** exempted **FPIs investing only in government securities** from disclosing **investor group** details, following RBI's **5 June 2026** circular that removed the concentration limit.
60. **SEBI** impounded about **Rs 28 crore** from **Prrsaar Sampada** and **Chaubara Eats** for cross-segment **price manipulation** using stock futures and options.
61. **NBFC gold loans** surged **68.5%** in July 2026 to about **Rs 3.54 trillion**, while banks' gold loan book stood at **Rs 5.52 trillion**; total NBFC credit grew **14.9% to Rs 59.89 trillion**.
62. **SBI General Insurance** posted **10.9% GDPI growth** to **Rs 3,506 crore** in Q1 FY27 and became the **first general insurer** to report under **Ind AS**.
63. **IRDAI** fined **ICICI Lombard Rs 1 crore** for lapses in **outsourcing and vendor management**.
64. **ICICI Prudential Life Insurance** was renamed **ICICI Life Insurance Limited** effective **22 September 2026**.
65. **LIC's AUM** stood at **Rs 59.39 trillion** at end-Q1 FY27; under **IRDAI** norms insurers can hold up to **15%** in a company.
66. **PFRDA** formed a committee to design a **guaranteed-return pension scheme** for the **non-government sector** and is working on **inflation-protected bonds**.
67. **Mastercard** exited **Pine Labs**, selling its entire **4.31% stake** for about **Rs 933 crore** via block deals on BSE.

D. Schemes, Appointments, Acquisitions and Awards

68. **ECLGS 5.0**, approved on **5 May 2026** and run by **NCGTC**, targets extra credit of up to **Rs 2.55 lakh crore** and is open till **31 March 2027**.
69. ECLGS 5.0 gives **100% guarantee to MSMEs** and **90% to non-MSMEs and airlines**, with **no guarantee fee**; extra credit is up to **20%** of peak Q4 FY26 working capital, capped at **Rs 100 crore**.
70. ECLGS 5.0 loans carry a **9% p.a.** ceiling for banks (MSMEs priced on **EBLR**, non-MSMEs on **MCLR**) and **13%** for NBFCs; MSME tenure is **5 years with a 1-year moratorium**; airlines can get up to **Rs 1,500 crore** over **7 years**.
71. By **20 August 2026**, **6.74 lakh guarantees** worth **Rs 2.50 lakh crore** were issued under ECLGS 5.0, with **MSMEs** forming **97.3%** by number; access is via the **Jan Samarth Portal**.
72. **PM Vishwakarma Scheme** completed **three years** with **30 lakh** registered artisans across **18 trades**.
73. **Ayushman Bharat PM-JAY**, launched from **Ranchi** in September 2018, completed **eight years**, covering over **60 crore** people with **Rs 5 lakh** annual cover.
74. The **Ministry of Cooperation** restored the **Sahara Refund Portal** (under **CRCS**) to clear about **20 lakh** pending claims; **Rs 9,267 crore** has already been refunded to **42 lakh** depositors.
75. **'OneTag'** FASTag portability on NHAI's **Rajmargyatra App** lets users switch issuer banks while keeping the same tag; a **6-month cooling period** applies before porting again.
76. The **Pashudhan Bima Portal** was launched to digitise **livestock insurance** policies and claims, available in **11 regional languages** plus Hindi and English.
77. **FM Nirmala Sitharaman** launched the **IITM Unicorn Frontier Fund-I** (an **AIF**) and released the book **'Cashless Nation: How UPI Changed Everything'** at **IITMAA Sangam 2026**, Bengaluru.
78. **Tamil Nadu** launched **Thaimaman Thanga Mothiram Thittam**, gifting a **one-gram 22-carat gold ring** to newborns in government hospitals, with **Rs 755.83 crore** annual outlay.
79. **Appointments (banking): Saurabh Kumar** became Govt Nominee Director on **Bank of Maharashtra** (replacing Abhijit Phukon), and **Abhinav Trivedi** became MD & CEO of **Standard Chartered Capital**.

80. **Appointments (insurance and markets): Tatsuya Fujimoto** is MD & CEO of **IFFCO-TOKIO General Insurance** (51:49 JV), and **Kinjal Shah** is **CTO of CDSL**, succeeding Amit Mahajan.
81. **Exits: Manish Kothari** quit **Kotak Mahindra Bank** after 31 years (MD & CEO: **Ashok Vaswani**), and **LIC MD Dinesh Pant** took voluntary retirement from 24 September 2026.
82. **Jayanti Prasad** got additional charge as **IBBI Chairperson** after **Ravi Mital** retired; **Yugal Tiwari** joined **BharatPe** (Resilient Innovations Pvt Ltd) as **Chief Product and Marketing Officer**.
83. Nobel laureate **Michael Kremer** becomes **World Bank Chief Economist** from **1 October 2026**, succeeding **Indermit Gill**.
84. **Acquisitions: Udaan** bought Swiggy's **LYNK Logistics** for **Rs 500 crore**; **Novartis India** bought Pfizer's **Minipress** brands for **Rs 1,250 crore**; **CCI** cleared **FIH Mauritius** (Fairfax) raising its stake in **IIFL Capital Services**.
85. **J&K Bank** (MD & CEO **Amitava Chatterjee**) won the **'Best CSR Overall Practices'** award at the **13th National CSR Leadership Congress** in Bengaluru.
86. **India–UAE** agreed on local-currency trade settlement, payment-system linkages and **CBDC** cooperation, targeting **$200 billion** trade by **2032**; the **India–New Zealand FTA** takes effect on **20 October 2026**.
87. The **18th BRICS Summit** was held at **Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi**, attended by **New Development Bank President Dilma Rousseff**.

September 2026 Banking & Financial Current Affairs
200 MCQs

Part A: RBI, Monetary Policy and Banking Regulation (Q1–50)

1. The RBI (Commercial Banks – Minimum Capital Requirements for Market Risk) Directions, 2026 will take effect from which date?

(a) 1 October 2026 (b) 1 January 2027 (c) 1 April 2027 (d) 1 April 2028

Answer: (c) 1 April 2027

2. RBI's new market risk capital directions for commercial banks align Indian rules with which global framework?

(a) Basel I (b) Revised Basel III (c) Basel II Pillar 3 (d) IFRS 9

Answer: (b) Revised Basel III

3. Under the final market risk directions, the trading book is identified through which accounting sub-classification?

(a) Held to Maturity (HTM) (b) Available for Sale (AFS) (c) Fair Value through OCI (d) Held for Trading (HFT)

Answer: (d) Held for Trading (HFT)

4. The specific risk tables for interest rate risk in RBI's market risk directions were revised to match the guidelines of which body?

(a) Basel Committee on Banking Supervision (BCBS) (b) Financial Stability Board (FSB) (c) IOSCO (d) IMF

Answer: (a) Basel Committee on Banking Supervision (BCBS)

5. RBI's market risk directions newly cover the capital treatment of positions hedged by which credit derivative?

(a) Interest rate futures (b) Total return swaps (c) Currency options (d) Forward rate agreements

Answer: (b) Total return swaps

6. RBI revised the valuation norms for InvIT and REIT units held by which category of institutions?

(a) Small Finance Banks (b) Urban Co-operative Banks (c) All-India Financial Institutions (AIFIs) (d) Regional Rural Banks

Answer: (c) All-India Financial Institutions (AIFIs)

7. Under RBI's revised norms, how are unquoted InvIT units held by AIFIs to be valued?

(a) At face value (b) At the Net Asset Value (NAV) disclosed by the InvIT (c) At book value (d) At last traded price

Answer: (b) At the Net Asset Value (NAV) disclosed by the InvIT

8. If an InvIT or REIT fails to calculate and disclose NAV as per SEBI regulations, at what value will its units be carried by AIFIs?

(a) Zero (b) Rs 10 (c) 50% of NAV (d) Rs 1

Answer: (d) Rs 1

9. In RBI's investment portfolio directions for AIFIs, which new paragraphs were inserted for InvITs and REITs respectively?

(a) 58A and 58B (b) 45A and 45B (c) 21A and 21B (d) 35A and 35B

Answer: (a) 58A and 58B

10. The InvIT/REIT valuation amendments were issued under which section of the RBI Act, 1934?

(a) Section 21 (b) Section 35A (c) Section 45L (d) Section 17

Answer: (c) Section 45L

11. Under RBI's draft framework on suspected mule accounts, banks will freeze only the disputed amount for unusual transfers of at least what value?

(a) Rs 500 (b) Rs 1,000 (c) Rs 5,000 (d) Rs 10,000

Answer: (b) Rs 1,000

12. Under the proposed debit-hold framework, how many calendar days will a customer get to prove the legitimacy of a flagged transaction?

(a) 7 days (b) 10 days (c) 15 days (d) 20 days

Answer: (d) 20 days

13. Once a customer responds, how many calendar days will the bank have to assess the explanation under the proposed mule-account rules?

(a) 10 days (b) 20 days (c) 30 days (d) 45 days

Answer: (a) 10 days

14. After a bank refers a suspected cyber-fraud case to police, within how many days must law enforcement issue a formal statutory restraint order?

(a) 15 days (b) 21 days (c) 30 days (d) 60 days

Answer: (c) 30 days

15. RBI's proposed targeted debit-hold framework for money-mule accounts followed a direction from which authority?

(a) Ministry of Home Affairs (b) Supreme Court of India (c) Financial Intelligence Unit-India (d) Parliament's Standing Committee on Finance

Answer: (b) Supreme Court of India

16. From which date does the Bankers' Books Evidence Act, 2026 come into force?

(a) 1 September 2026 (b) 1 October 2026 (c) 1 January 2027 (d) 1 April 2027

Answer: (b) 1 October 2026

17. The Bankers' Books Evidence Act, 2026 follows what kind of approach towards banking records?

(a) Paper-only approach (b) Technology-neutral approach (c) Blockchain-mandatory approach (d) Court-certified-only approach

Answer: (b) Technology-neutral approach

18. On which date did RBI operationalise its concessional forex swap facility for fresh FCNR(B) deposits, OFCBs and ECBs?

(a) 5 June 2026 (b) 8 June 2026 (c) 1 July 2026 (d) 31 August 2026

Answer: (b) 8 June 2026

19. RBI closed the window for fresh FCNR(B) deposits under the swap facility on 31 August 2026. What was the original deadline?

(a) 15 September 2026 (b) 30 September 2026 (c) 31 October 2026 (d) 31 December 2026

Answer: (b) 30 September 2026

20. Till 18 September 2026, RBI's special USD-INR swap window had attracted total inflows of about how much?

(a) $90 billion (b) $127.2 billion (c) $136.7 billion (d) $143.6 billion

Answer: (d) $143.6 billion

21. Up to which date do the concessional swap facilities for ECBs and OFCBs remain open?

(a) 31 August 2026 (b) 30 September 2026 (c) 31 December 2026 (d) 31 March 2027

Answer: (c) 31 December 2026

22. The similar FCNR(B) swap scheme launched in 2013 had mobilised roughly how much?

(a) $10 billion (b) $26 billion (c) $54 billion (d) $90 billion

Answer: (b) $26 billion

23. Under RBI's 2026 swap scheme, banks could mobilise fresh FCNR(B) deposits of what maturity?

(a) 1 to 2 years (b) 3 to 5 years (c) 5 to 7 years (d) 7 to 10 years

Answer: (b) 3 to 5 years

24. Bank deposit growth in the fortnight ended 31 August 2026 touched 17.8%, the highest since which year?

(a) 2008 (b) 2011 (c) 2016 (d) 2020

Answer: (b) 2011

25. Following the FCNR(B) inflows, the gap between bank credit growth and deposit growth narrowed to how many basis points?

(a) 50 bps (b) 130 bps (c) 250 bps (d) 550 bps

Answer: (b) 130 bps

26. What was the incremental credit-deposit ratio of banks as of 31 August 2026?

(a) 62.56% (b) 80.32% (c) 81.72% (d) 92.22%

Answer: (a) 62.56%

27. What was bank credit growth in the fortnight ended 31 August 2026?

(a) 14.9% (b) 17.8% (c) 19.1% (d) 22.6%

Answer: (c) 19.1%

28. How much did ICICI Bank mobilise in FCNR(B) deposits under RBI's scheme till 31 August 2026?

(a) $2 billion (b) $10 billion (c) $13.6 billion (d) $17.9 billion

Answer: (d) $17.9 billion

29. Which private lender said it mobilised about $2 billion via FCNR(B) deposits, choosing not to be 'overly active'?

(a) HDFC Bank (b) Yes Bank (c) IndusInd Bank (d) Kotak Mahindra Bank

Answer: (b) Yes Bank

30. RBI's forex forward position climbed to an all-time high in July 2026. What was the figure?

(a) $96.4 billion (b) $112.5 billion (c) $136.7 billion (d) $150.2 billion

Answer: (c) $136.7 billion

31. RBI imposed a penalty of Rs 27.30 lakh on Asset Care & Reconstruction Enterprise (ACRE) for lapses relating to what?

(a) KYC norms (b) Charging of management fees (c) Auction procedure (d) Priority sector lending

Answer: (b) Charging of management fees

32. The penalty on ACRE, an asset reconstruction company, was imposed under which Act?

(a) Banking Regulation Act, 1949 (b) SARFAESI Act, 2002 (c) Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007 (d) Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, 2016

Answer: (b) SARFAESI Act, 2002

33. RBI fined Ola Financial Services Rs 3.10 lakh for non-compliance with directions on which subject?

(a) Fair Practices Code (b) Know Your Customer (KYC) (c) Digital lending (d) Outsourcing

Answer: (b) Know Your Customer (KYC)

34. The penalty on Ola Financial Services was imposed under which law?

(a) RBI Act, 1934 (b) FEMA, 1999 (c) Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007 (d) PMLA, 2002

Answer: (c) Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007

35. KLM Axiva Finvest was penalised Rs 2.70 lakh by RBI for violating directions on what?

(a) Auction procedure (b) Interest charging (c) Loan recovery agents (d) Credit card issuance

Answer: (a) Auction procedure

36. Hero Fincorp was fined Rs 10 lakh for non-compliance with which RBI directions?

(a) KYC Directions (b) Fair Practices Code for Lenders – Charging of Interest (c) Credit Information Reporting (d) Gold loan LTV norms

Answer: (b) Fair Practices Code for Lenders – Charging of Interest

37. In September 2026, RBI cancelled the Certificates of Registration of how many NBFCs, while how many others surrendered them?

(a) 3 cancelled, 5 surrendered (b) 5 cancelled, 8 surrendered (c) 8 cancelled, 5 surrendered (d) 6 cancelled, 6 surrendered

Answer: (b) 5 cancelled, 8 surrendered

38. Which entity surrendered its NBFC registration after qualifying as an unregistered Core Investment Company (CIC)?

(a) CDN Finance (b) Anagram Industries (c) Parsoli Corporation (d) Rolta Holding and Finance

Answer: (b) Anagram Industries

39. RNFI Services received RBI's in-principle authorisation to operate as which type of payment aggregator?

(a) Payment Aggregator – Online (PA-O) (b) Payment Aggregator – Cross-Border (PA-CB) (c) Payment Aggregator – Physical (PA-P) (d) Bharat Bill Payment Operating Unit

Answer: (c) Payment Aggregator – Physical (PA-P)

40. Pluxee India received RBI authorisation as a Payment Aggregator for which segments?

(a) Only online (PA-O) (b) Only physical (PA-P) (c) Both online (PA-O) and physical (PA-P) (d) Cross-border only

Answer: (c) Both online (PA-O) and physical (PA-P)

41. Jio Payment Solutions Ltd (JPSL), a subsidiary of Jio Financial Services, received RBI authorisation for which category?

(a) Payment Aggregator – Cross-Border (PA-CB) (b) Small Finance Bank (c) Account Aggregator (d) Payments Bank

Answer: (a) Payment Aggregator – Cross-Border (PA-CB)

42. PB Pay, the payment aggregator platform of PB Fintech, was licensed by RBI in which month?

(a) August 2025 (b) December 2025 (c) February 2026 (d) June 2026

Answer: (c) February 2026

43. Suman Ray, appointed RBI Executive Director from 1 September 2026, will look after which areas?

(a) Monetary Policy and Currency Management (b) DICGC and the Premises Department (c) Supervision and Regulation (d) Foreign Exchange and Internal Debt Management

Answer: (b) DICGC and the Premises Department

44. Before being elevated as RBI Executive Director, Suman Ray was Regional Director for which state?

(a) Gujarat (b) West Bengal (c) Maharashtra (d) Karnataka

Answer: (c) Maharashtra

45. RBI permitted LIC to raise its aggregate holding in ICICI Bank up to what level, within one year?

(a) 4.99% (b) 9.99% (c) 14.99% (d) 26%

Answer: (b) 9.99%

46. What was LIC's stake in ICICI Bank as of 30 June 2026?

(a) 2.15% (b) 4.35% (c) 7.80% (d) 9.99%

Answer: (b) 4.35%

47. What is the current policy repo rate, which the MPC kept unchanged at its last meeting?

(a) 5.00% (b) 5.25% (c) 5.50% (d) 6.00%

Answer: (b) 5.25%

48. What are the current Cash Reserve Ratio (CRR) and Statutory Liquidity Ratio (SLR) respectively?

(a) 4% and 18% (b) 3% and 18% (c) 3% and 19.5% (d) 4.5% and 18%

Answer: (b) 3% and 18%

49. What is the current Marginal Standing Facility (MSF) rate, which is equal to the Bank Rate?

(a) 5.00% (b) 5.25% (c) 5.50% (d) 5.75%

Answer: (c) 5.50%

50. At GFF 2026, RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra highlighted which RBI-backed credit infrastructure aimed at frictionless lending?

(a) Unified Lending Interface (ULI) (b) Account Aggregator Hub (c) Bharat Bill Payment System (d) National Automated Clearing House

Answer: (a) Unified Lending Interface (ULI)

Part B: Banks, Payments, UPI and Fintech (Q51–100)

51. Where was the 7th Global Fintech Fest (GFF) 2026 held from 9–11 September 2026?

(a) Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi (b) Jio World Centre, Mumbai (c) GIFT City, Gandhinagar (d) BIEC, Bengaluru

Answer: (b) Jio World Centre, Mumbai

52. What was the theme of GFF 2026?

(a) Financing Viksit Bharat (b) Potential to Impact: Agentic AI · Tokenisation · Quantum (c) Empowering Finance for a Better World (d) Blueprint for a Digital Future

Answer: (b) Potential to Impact: Agentic AI · Tokenisation · Quantum

53. Which of the following was NOT an organiser of GFF 2026?

(a) Payments Council of India (PCI) (b) National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) (c) Fintech Convergence Council (FCC) (d) Indian Banks' Association (IBA)

Answer: (d) Indian Banks' Association (IBA)

54. As highlighted at GFF 2026, UPI currently operates in how many countries?

(a) 7 (b) 9 (c) 11 (d) 15

Answer: (c) 11

55. At GFF 2026, the Department of Financial Services allowed which borrowers to use their sanctioned credit limits directly for merchant payments via UPI?

(a) PM SVANidhi and Stand-Up India (b) Kisan Credit Card (KCC) and PM MUDRA Yojana (c) PMAY and Education loans (d) Credit card and BNPL users

Answer: (b) Kisan Credit Card (KCC) and PM MUDRA Yojana

56. Which state announced its vision to become India's first 'tokenised state' at GFF 2026?

(a) Gujarat (b) Karnataka (c) Maharashtra (d) Telangana

Answer: (c) Maharashtra

57. Who is the MD & CEO of Bank of Baroda, who announced higher investment in cybersecurity at GFF 2026?

(a) Debadatta Chand (b) Ashok Vaswani (c) Amitabh Chaudhry (d) Rajneesh Karnatak

Answer: (a) Debadatta Chand

58. The new UPI tap-to-pay feature at Point-of-Sale terminals works on which technology?

(a) Bluetooth Low Energy (b) QR code (c) Near-Field Communication (NFC) (d) USSD

Answer: (c) Near-Field Communication (NFC)

59. Up to what amount can UPI tap-to-pay transactions be made without entering the UPI PIN?

(a) Rs 500 (b) Rs 2,000 (c) Rs 5,000 (d) Rs 10,000

Answer: (c) Rs 5,000

60. The new UPI customer support solution runs on a small language model called FiMI. What does FiMI stand for?

(a) Fintech Model for India (b) Finance Model for India (c) Financial Intelligence Model for Inclusion (d) Federated Indian Model Interface

Answer: (b) Finance Model for India

61. What Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) has NPCI introduced on P2M UPI transactions above Rs 2,000?

(a) 0.2% (b) 0.3% (c) 0.4% (d) 1%

Answer: (c) 0.4%

62. From which date does the new UPI MDR framework take effect?

(a) 1 October 2026 (b) 15 October 2026 (c) 1 November 2026 (d) 1 January 2027

Answer: (b) 15 October 2026

63. Under the new UPI MDR framework, what is the maximum MDR on purchases of Rs 75,000 and above?

(a) Rs 100 (b) Rs 200 (c) Rs 300 (d) Rs 500

Answer: (c) Rs 300

64. What flat MDR applies to UPI payments above Rs 2,000 for railways, telecom, insurance and fuel?

(a) Rs 2 per transaction (b) Rs 5 per transaction (c) Rs 10 per transaction (d) Nil

Answer: (b) Rs 5 per transaction

65. What MDR applies to UPI payments for capital market transactions such as mutual funds and stockbrokers?

(a) 0.02%, capped at Rs 300 (b) 0.1%, capped at Rs 100 (c) 0.4%, no cap (d) Fully exempt

Answer: (a) 0.02%, capped at Rs 300

66. Under the revenue-sharing mechanism for the 40 bps UPI MDR, what share goes to issuer banks?

(a) 10% (b) 20% (c) 30% (d) 40%

Answer: (d) 40%

67. Which committee finalised the new UPI MDR framework?

(a) UPI and Services Steering Committee (b) Board for Regulation and Supervision of Payment Systems (c) Nilekani Committee (d) Financial Stability and Development Council

Answer: (a) UPI and Services Steering Committee

68. Small merchants receiving up to what amount per month through UPI QR remain exempt from MDR?

(a) Rs 25,000 (b) Rs 50,000 (c) Rs 1 lakh (d) Rs 2 lakh

Answer: (c) Rs 1 lakh

69. The zero-MDR regime for UPI merchant transactions, now ending, was introduced in which month?

(a) January 2020 (b) April 2019 (c) November 2016 (d) January 2022

Answer: (a) January 2020

70. According to NPCI, roughly how much does it cost annually to operate UPI?

(a) Rs 5,000 crore (b) Rs 10,000 crore (c) Rs 20,000 crore (d) Rs 50,000 crore

Answer: (c) Rs 20,000 crore

71. What is the per-transaction UPI limit for capital market payments?

(a) Rs 1 lakh (b) Rs 2 lakh (c) Rs 5 lakh (d) Rs 10 lakh

Answer: (c) Rs 5 lakh

72. NPCI's Bharat Connect platform is developing which new product to standardise netbanking?

(a) NetPay Plus (b) Netbanking 2.0 (c) e-Banking Grid (d) Bharat NetLink

Answer: (b) Netbanking 2.0

73. UPI set a record of how many transactions in August 2026?

(a) 20.01 billion (b) 23.66 billion (c) 24.51 billion (d) 25.90 billion

Answer: (c) 24.51 billion

74. What was the total value of UPI transactions in August 2026?

(a) Rs 24.85 trillion (b) Rs 29.82 trillion (c) Rs 29.90 trillion (d) Rs 31.20 trillion

Answer: (b) Rs 29.82 trillion

75. By how much did UPI transaction volume grow year-on-year in August 2026?

(a) 12% (b) 18% (c) 22% (d) 30%

Answer: (c) 22%

76. What was the average daily UPI transaction volume in August 2026?

(a) 650 million (b) 763 million (c) 791 million (d) 850 million

Answer: (c) 791 million

77. How many IMPS transactions were recorded in August 2026?

(a) 354 million (b) 360 million (c) 364 million (d) 412 million

Answer: (b) 360 million

78. Which two agentic AI platforms did NPCI launch at GFF 2026?

(a) AiNxt and AtOM (b) FiMI and UPI Help (c) Hello UPI and BHIM Vega (d) UPI Circle and UPI Lite X

Answer: (a) AiNxt and AtOM

79. What does AtOM, launched by NPCI, stand for?

(a) Automated Transaction Operations Manager (b) Agentic Orchestration & Messaging (c) AI Toolkit for Online Merchants (d) Agent-to-Operator Model

Answer: (b) Agentic Orchestration & Messaging

80. NPCI's AiNxt platform follows which approach to AI models?

(a) Single proprietary model (b) Bring-Your-Own-Model (BYOM) (c) Open-source only (d) Government-hosted model only

Answer: (b) Bring-Your-Own-Model (BYOM)

81. Which tool did UIDAI unveil at GFF 2026 to help developers integrate Aadhaar-based face authentication?

(a) Aadhaar FaceRD 2.0 (b) Face Auth SDK & Sandbox (c) mAadhaar Face Pay (d) e-KYC Lite

Answer: (b) Face Auth SDK & Sandbox

82. PhonePe partnered with which card network at GFF 2026 to offer cardless Tap to Pay, Cross Border Scan to Pay and Smart Accept?

(a) Mastercard (b) RuPay (c) Visa (d) American Express

Answer: (c) Visa

83. Which became the first Indian bank to offer Apple Pay to its Visa and Mastercard credit card customers?

(a) HDFC Bank (b) ICICI Bank (c) Axis Bank (d) SBI Card

Answer: (c) Axis Bank

84. What was the theme of Axis Bank's 'Sparsh Week 2026' held from 7–11 September?

(a) Customer First (b) Act with Speed (c) Dil Se Open (d) Badhti Ka Naam Zindagi

Answer: (b) Act with Speed

85. During Sparsh Week 2026, Axis Bank introduced a paperless auto and two-wheeler loan journey with application-to-disbursement in how much time?

(a) 5 minutes (b) 15 minutes (c) 30 minutes (d) 2 hours

Answer: (c) 30 minutes

86. SBI has announced an aggressive push into the wealth management market of what size?

(a) Rs 1.2 lakh crore (b) Rs 2.4 lakh crore (c) Rs 4.6 lakh crore (d) Rs 10 lakh crore

Answer: (b) Rs 2.4 lakh crore

87. SBI launched a digital Savings-to-Salary Account journey at GFF 2026 in collaboration with which fintech?

(a) ScoreMe Solutions (b) Perfios (c) Setu (d) Zeta

Answer: (a) ScoreMe Solutions

88. State Bank of India was founded on which date?

(a) 1 April 1935 (b) 1 July 1955 (c) 19 July 1969 (d) 27 January 1921

Answer: (b) 1 July 1955

89. India Post Payments Bank (IPPB) celebrated which Foundation Day in September 2026?

(a) 7th (b) 8th (c) 9th (d) 10th

Answer: (c) 9th

90. Which product did IPPB launch for merchants on its Foundation Day 2026?

(a) DakPay Sound Box (b) Dak Card Swipe (c) IPPB Merchant Lite (d) PostPay QR Plus

Answer: (a) DakPay Sound Box

91. As of 31 March 2026, what was IPPB's pan-India customer base?

(a) 9.47 crore (b) 11.5 crore (c) 13.25 crore (d) 15.6 crore

Answer: (c) 13.25 crore

92. IPPB's 'Surakshit Savings Account' offers cyber-insurance cover of how much against phishing, spoofing and SIM jacking?

(a) Rs 10,000 (b) Rs 25,000 (c) Rs 50,000 (d) Rs 1 lakh

Answer: (b) Rs 25,000

93. India Post Payments Bank functions under which ministry?

(a) Ministry of Finance (b) Ministry of Communications (c) Ministry of Rural Development (d) Ministry of Electronics and IT

Answer: (b) Ministry of Communications

94. Indian Bank received board approval to open a representative office in which city?

(a) Singapore (b) London (c) Dubai (d) Colombo

Answer: (c) Dubai

95. Which bank was amalgamated with Indian Bank in 2020?

(a) Allahabad Bank (b) Andhra Bank (c) Syndicate Bank (d) Corporation Bank

Answer: (a) Allahabad Bank

96. Canara Bank has reportedly committed over Rs 50 crore for compliance with which law?

(a) IT Act, 2000 (b) Digital Personal Data Protection Act (DPDPA) (c) PMLA, 2002 (d) Consumer Protection Act, 2019

Answer: (b) Digital Personal Data Protection Act (DPDPA)

97. novio, the consumer credit platform of Credilio, partnered with which public sector bank to launch a co-branded RuPay credit card?

(a) Punjab National Bank (b) Indian Overseas Bank (c) UCO Bank (d) Bank of India

Answer: (b) Indian Overseas Bank

98. The novio–IOB co-branded RuPay credit card is available in which two variants?

(a) RuPay Classic and Gold (b) RuPay Select and RuPay Platinum (c) RuPay Signature and Infinite (d) RuPay Lite and Prime

Answer: (b) RuPay Select and RuPay Platinum

99. Kissht, an RBI-registered NBFC, roped in which sports personality as brand ambassador for its 'Loans Without Any Hiccups' campaign?

(a) Virat Kohli (b) MS Dhoni (c) Sachin Tendulkar (d) Neeraj Chopra

Answer: (c) Sachin Tendulkar

100. Pluxee India, which received RBI's Payment Aggregator licence, issues its benefit cards on which card network?

(a) Visa (b) Mastercard (c) RuPay (d) Diners Club

Answer: (c) RuPay

Part C: Economy, Markets, Insurance, Ratings and Reports (Q101–150)

101. What was India's GDP growth in Q1 (April–June) of FY27?

(a) 6.9% (b) 7.0% (c) 7.4% (d) 7.8%

Answer: (d) 7.8%

102. The IMF described India as a 'key engine of global growth'. Which IMF official made these remarks?

(a) Kristalina Georgieva (b) Gita Gopinath (c) Julie Kozak (d) Pierre-Olivier Gourinchas

Answer: (c) Julie Kozak

103. HSBC India Manufacturing PMI fell to 52.8 in August 2026, its lowest level since?

(a) March 2020 (b) August 2021 (c) January 2023 (d) June 2024

Answer: (b) August 2021

104. What is the long-run average of India's Manufacturing PMI mentioned in the August 2026 data?

(a) 50.0 (b) 52.3 (c) 54.2 (d) 56.5

Answer: (c) 54.2

105. Japan Credit Rating Agency (JCR) upgraded India's long-term issuer rating from 'BBB+' to what?

(a) A (b) A- (c) A+ (d) BBB

Answer: (b) A-

106. JCR also raised India's country ceiling by one notch to which level?

(a) A- (b) A (c) A+ (d) AA-

Answer: (b) A

107. As noted by JCR, the Centre's fiscal deficit fell from 4.7% in FY25 to what level in FY26?

(a) 4.0% (b) 4.2% (c) 4.4% (d) 4.5%

Answer: (c) 4.4%

108. Fitch Ratings raised India's FY27 GDP growth forecast from 6.4% to what?

(a) 6.6% (b) 6.9% (c) 7.1% (d) 7.3%

Answer: (b) 6.9%

109. Fitch expects RBI to hike the policy rate by 25 bps in October 2026 to which level?

(a) 5.25% (b) 5.50% (c) 5.75% (d) 6.00%

Answer: (b) 5.50%

110. S&P Global Ratings raised India's FY27 real GDP growth forecast to 7% from what earlier estimate?

(a) 6.3% (b) 6.4% (c) 6.6% (d) 6.8%

Answer: (c) 6.6%

111. What average consumer inflation does S&P project for India in FY27?

(a) 4.0% (b) 4.6% (c) 5.1% (d) 5.8%

Answer: (c) 5.1%

112. OECD raised India's FY27 growth forecast by 80 bps to what level in its September Interim Economic Outlook?

(a) 6.5% (b) 6.9% (c) 7.0% (d) 7.1%

Answer: (d) 7.1%

113. What growth has OECD projected for India in FY28?

(a) 6.0% (b) 6.5% (c) 7.1% (d) 7.8%

Answer: (b) 6.5%

114. What was India's WPI-based inflation in August 2026?

(a) 7.05% (b) 8.37% (c) 9.78% (d) 9.92%

Answer: (d) 9.92%

115. What was WPI inflation in the fuel and power basket in August 2026?

(a) 8.37% (b) 12.40% (c) 18.15% (d) 22.93%

Answer: (d) 22.93%

116. What retail inflation did RBI's MPC project for FY27, citing a deficient monsoon amid El Nino?

(a) 4% (b) 4.5% (c) 5% (d) 5.5%

Answer: (c) 5%

117. How much did private corporations invest in fixed assets in FY25, as per detailed GFCF data?

(a) Rs 24.2 trillion (b) Rs 28.3 trillion (c) Rs 30.3 trillion (d) Rs 99.76 trillion

Answer: (c) Rs 30.3 trillion

118. NSO's first-ever district-level estimates of the unincorporated non-agricultural sector are based on which survey?

(a) PLFS 2025 (b) ASUSE 2025 (c) ASI 2024-25 (d) HCES 2024

Answer: (b) ASUSE 2025

119. As per ASUSE 2025 district estimates, what is the national average GVA per worker in the unincorporated sector?

(a) Rs 1,00,000 (b) Rs 1,25,400 (c) Rs 1,56,539 (d) Rs 1,98,250

Answer: (c) Rs 1,56,539

120. India's textile exports in August 2026 grew 16.1% year-on-year to how much?

(a) Rs 25,656 crore (b) Rs 29,776 crore (c) Rs 33,410 crore (d) Rs 1.43 lakh crore

Answer: (b) Rs 29,776 crore

121. S&P Global Ratings assigned what long-term issuer credit rating to Bank of India?

(a) BBB- (b) BBB (c) BBB+ (d) A-

Answer: (b) BBB

122. In WEF's Chief Economists' Outlook, India slipped to which position for favourable business environment for MNCs?

(a) Second (b) Third (c) Fourth (d) Fifth

Answer: (c) Fourth

123. According to Oxford Economics' 2026 Global Cities Index, Delhi could become the world's ___ largest city economy by 2050.

(a) 5th (b) 14th (c) 36th (d) 63rd

Answer: (b) 14th

124. Oxford Economics projects Bengaluru's real GDP to grow at what average annual rate during 2026–2030?

(a) 7.5% (b) 8.1% (c) 9.2% (d) 10.4%

Answer: (c) 9.2%

125. SEBI approved the IPO of Jio Platforms. What is the proposed issue size?

(a) Rs 27,859 crore (b) Rs 32,500 crore (c) Rs 37,700 crore (d) Rs 45,000 crore

Answer: (c) Rs 37,700 crore

126. If completed, the Jio Platforms IPO will surpass whose offering to become India's largest IPO?

(a) LIC (b) Paytm (c) Hyundai Motor India (d) Coal India

Answer: (c) Hyundai Motor India

127. Which firm is the lead manager for the Jio Platforms IPO?

(a) SBI Capital Markets (b) Kotak Mahindra Capital Company (c) ICICI Securities (d) JM Financial

Answer: (b) Kotak Mahindra Capital Company

128. For how long does SEBI's observation (approval) for the Jio Platforms IPO remain valid?

(a) 3 months (b) 6 months (c) 12 months (d) 18 months

Answer: (c) 12 months

129. From which date was the Closing Auction Session (CAS) introduced in the equity cash segment for F&O stocks?

(a) 1 July 2026 (b) 3 August 2026 (c) 1 September 2026 (d) 3 October 2026

Answer: (b) 3 August 2026

130. SEBI proposed that exchanges stop disseminating which value during the Closing Auction Session?

(a) Indicative Index Value (IIV) (b) Implied Volatility (c) Last Traded Price (d) Open Interest

Answer: (a) Indicative Index Value (IIV)

131. Expiry-day settlement prices for derivatives are currently based on VWAP of trades in the last how many minutes of continuous trading?

(a) 10 minutes (b) 15 minutes (c) 30 minutes (d) 60 minutes

Answer: (c) 30 minutes

132. SEBI exempted which FPIs from furnishing investor group details?

(a) FPIs investing only in equity (b) FPIs investing only in government securities (c) Category III FPIs (d) FPIs from FATF grey-list countries

Answer: (b) FPIs investing only in government securities

133. SEBI impounded about Rs 28 crore from Prrsaar Sampada and Chaubara Eats for what violation?

(a) Insider trading (b) Cross-segment price manipulation (c) Front-running (d) IPO fund diversion

Answer: (b) Cross-segment price manipulation

134. Gold loans by NBFCs grew by how much year-on-year in July 2026?

(a) 43.9% (b) 68.5% (c) 88.1% (d) 136.4%

Answer: (b) 68.5%

135. What was the outstanding gold loan book of banks at the end of July 2026?

(a) Rs 3.54 trillion (b) Rs 4.10 trillion (c) Rs 5.52 trillion (d) Rs 8.55 trillion

Answer: (c) Rs 5.52 trillion

136. Overall credit extended by NBFCs rose 14.9% in July 2026 to how much?

(a) Rs 26.06 trillion (b) Rs 41.35 trillion (c) Rs 59.89 trillion (d) Rs 80.27 trillion

Answer: (c) Rs 59.89 trillion

137. SBI General Insurance reported Gross Direct Premium Income (GDPI) growth of how much in Q1 FY27?

(a) 8.4% (b) 10.9% (c) 17.4% (d) 26.3%

Answer: (b) 10.9%

138. SBI General Insurance became the first general insurer to release financial statements under which framework?

(a) IFRS 17 (b) Ind AS (c) US GAAP (d) Solvency II

Answer: (b) Ind AS

139. IRDAI imposed a Rs 1 crore penalty on which insurer for outsourcing and vendor management lapses?

(a) HDFC ERGO (b) Bajaj Allianz (c) ICICI Lombard (d) Tata AIG

Answer: (c) ICICI Lombard

140. ICICI Prudential Life Insurance changed its name to what, effective 22 September 2026?

(a) ICICI Life Insurance Limited (b) ICICI Pru Life Limited (c) ICICI Assurance Limited (d) ICICI Jeevan Bima Limited

Answer: (a) ICICI Life Insurance Limited

141. Under IRDAI norms, insurers can acquire up to what stake in a company, depending on asset size?

(a) 5% (b) 10% (c) 15% (d) 26%

Answer: (c) 15%

142. What were LIC's assets under management at the end of Q1 FY27?

(a) Rs 45.3 trillion (b) Rs 52.8 trillion (c) Rs 59.39 trillion (d) Rs 65.1 trillion

Answer: (c) Rs 59.39 trillion

143. Mastercard exited Pine Labs by selling its entire stake of what size?

(a) 2.10% (b) 3.50% (c) 4.31% (d) 5.25%

Answer: (c) 4.31%

144. PFRDA set up a committee to design what kind of product for the non-government sector?

(a) Gold-linked pension (b) Guaranteed-return pension scheme (c) Micro-pension for gig workers (d) Pension-backed home loan

Answer: (b) Guaranteed-return pension scheme

145. Spacetech firm Pixxel raised $100 million in Series C, co-led by which investors?

(a) SoftBank and Tiger Global (b) Temasek and Seraphim (c) Sequoia and Accel (d) GIC and Blackstone

Answer: (b) Temasek and Seraphim

146. Ola Electric's board approved raising up to how much via a rights issue of partly paid-up shares?

(a) Rs 500 crore (b) Rs 780 crore (c) Rs 1,000 crore (d) Rs 1,500 crore

Answer: (c) Rs 1,000 crore

147. CCI approved the acquisition of additional equity in IIFL Capital Services by which entity?

(a) Bain Capital (b) FIH Mauritius Investments (c) Fairfax Financial UK (d) Temasek Holdings

Answer: (b) FIH Mauritius Investments

148. What is the approximate cost of the Western Dedicated Freight Corridor dedicated to the nation by PM Modi?

(a) Rs 51,000 crore (b) Rs 73,000 crore (c) Rs 1.24 trillion (d) Rs 12,000 crore

Answer: (b) Rs 73,000 crore

149. The Western DFC connects Dadri in Uttar Pradesh with which port?

(a) Mundra Port (b) Kandla Port (c) Jawaharlal Nehru Port Authority (JNPA) (d) Pipavav Port

Answer: (c) Jawaharlal Nehru Port Authority (JNPA)

150. India's domestic coal production in FY 2025-26 crossed the 1 billion tonne mark for the second year, reaching how much?

(a) 0.98 BT (b) 1.02 BT (c) 1.04 BT (d) 1.10 BT

Answer: (c) 1.04 BT

Part D: Schemes, Appointments, Acquisitions and Awards (Q151–200)

151. On which date did the Government approve the Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme (ECLGS) 5.0?

(a) 1 February 2026 (b) 5 May 2026 (c) 8 June 2026 (d) 20 August 2026

Answer: (b) 5 May 2026

152. Which body implements ECLGS 5.0?

(a) SIDBI (b) CGTMSE (c) National Credit Guarantee Trustee Company (NCGTC) (d) NABARD

Answer: (c) National Credit Guarantee Trustee Company (NCGTC)

153. ECLGS 5.0 aims to facilitate additional credit flow of up to how much?

(a) Rs 1.5 lakh crore (b) Rs 2.55 lakh crore (c) Rs 3.68 lakh crore (d) Rs 5 lakh crore

Answer: (b) Rs 2.55 lakh crore

154. Up to which date will ECLGS 5.0 remain operational (unless the guarantee cap is reached earlier)?

(a) 31 December 2026 (b) 31 March 2027 (c) 30 September 2027 (d) 31 March 2028

Answer: (b) 31 March 2027

155. What guarantee coverage does ECLGS 5.0 offer for eligible MSMEs and non-MSMEs respectively?

(a) 75% and 50% (b) 90% and 75% (c) 100% and 90% (d) 100% and 100%

Answer: (c) 100% and 90%

156. Under ECLGS 5.0, MSMEs and non-MSMEs can get additional credit of up to what share of their peak fund-based working capital in Q4 FY26?

(a) 10% (b) 20% (c) 25% (d) 40%

Answer: (b) 20%

157. What is the per-borrower ceiling for additional credit to MSMEs and non-MSMEs under ECLGS 5.0?

(a) Rs 25 crore (b) Rs 50 crore (c) Rs 100 crore (d) Rs 500 crore

Answer: (c) Rs 100 crore

158. What is the overall interest rate ceiling on bank loans under ECLGS 5.0?

(a) 7.5% p.a. (b) 8% p.a. (c) 9% p.a. (d) 13% p.a.

Answer: (c) 9% p.a.

159. Under ECLGS 5.0, loans to MSMEs are priced with reference to which benchmark?

(a) MCLR (b) EBLR (c) Base Rate (d) T-bill rate

Answer: (b) EBLR

160. What is the loan tenure for MSME borrowers under ECLGS 5.0?

(a) 3 years with 6-month moratorium (b) 4 years with 1-year moratorium (c) 5 years with 1-year moratorium (d) 7 years with 2-year moratorium

Answer: (c) 5 years with 1-year moratorium

161. What is the maximum additional credit per borrower for scheduled passenger airlines under ECLGS 5.0?

(a) Rs 500 crore (b) Rs 1,000 crore (c) Rs 1,500 crore (d) Rs 2,000 crore

Answer: (c) Rs 1,500 crore

162. The original ECLGS was launched in 2020 under which package?

(a) Garib Kalyan Package (b) Aatmanirbhar Bharat Package (c) Startup India Package (d) Make in India Package

Answer: (b) Aatmanirbhar Bharat Package

163. Through which portal is digital access to ECLGS 5.0 provided?

(a) Udyam Portal (b) Jan Samarth Portal (c) PSB Loans in 59 Minutes (d) TReDS

Answer: (b) Jan Samarth Portal

164. As of 20 August 2026, MSMEs accounted for what share of all guarantees issued under ECLGS 5.0 by number?

(a) 80.79% (b) 88.5% (c) 92.1% (d) 97.3%

Answer: (d) 97.3%

165. PM Vishwakarma Scheme completed three years with how many registered beneficiaries?

(a) 10 lakh (b) 20 lakh (c) 30 lakh (d) 50 lakh

Answer: (c) 30 lakh

166. PM Vishwakarma Scheme supports artisans and craftspeople in how many identified trades?

(a) 12 (b) 15 (c) 18 (d) 21

Answer: (c) 18

167. Ayushman Bharat PM-JAY, which completed eight years, was launched in September 2018 from which city?

(a) New Delhi (b) Ranchi (c) Varanasi (d) Lucknow

Answer: (b) Ranchi

168. Under Ayushman Bharat PM-JAY, what is the annual health cover per family?

(a) Rs 2 lakh (b) Rs 3 lakh (c) Rs 5 lakh (d) Rs 10 lakh

Answer: (c) Rs 5 lakh

169. What is the name of Tamil Nadu's one-gram gold ring scheme for newborns?

(a) Pudhumai Penn Thittam (b) Thaimaman Thanga Mothiram Thittam (c) Kalaignar Magalir Urimai Thittam (d) Moovalur Ramamirtham Thittam

Answer: (b) Thaimaman Thanga Mothiram Thittam

170. Which ministry restored the 'Sahara Refund Portal' to process about 2 million pending claims?

(a) Ministry of Finance (b) Ministry of Corporate Affairs (c) Ministry of Cooperation (d) Ministry of Consumer Affairs

Answer: (c) Ministry of Cooperation

171. How much has been refunded so far to Sahara cooperative depositors through the portal?

(a) Rs 5,000 crore (b) Rs 7,500 crore (c) Rs 9,267 crore (d) Rs 12,400 crore

Answer: (c) Rs 9,267 crore

172. The 'OneTag' FASTag portability service is hosted on which app?

(a) Rajmargyatra App (b) mParivahan App (c) BHIM App (d) UMANG App

Answer: (a) Rajmargyatra App

173. After porting, what is the cooling period before an interoperable FASTag can be ported again?

(a) 1 month (b) 3 months (c) 6 months (d) 12 months

Answer: (c) 6 months

174. The Pashudhan Bima Portal launched by the Government is meant for what purpose?

(a) Crop insurance claims (b) Livestock insurance issuance and claims (c) Fisheries credit (d) Dairy cooperative loans

Answer: (b) Livestock insurance issuance and claims

175. Under PM-RKVY, sanction letters worth over Rs 1,200 crore were given to 10 states. Which state got the highest amount (Rs 290 crore)?

(a) Haryana (b) Bihar (c) West Bengal (d) Chhattisgarh

Answer: (c) West Bengal

176. Which Alternative Investment Fund was launched by Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman at IITMAA Sangam 2026 in Bengaluru?

(a) IITM Deep Tech Fund (b) IITM Unicorn Frontier Fund-I (c) Bharat Innovation Fund II (d) Madras Ventures Fund

Answer: (b) IITM Unicorn Frontier Fund-I

177. Which book on UPI was released by the Finance Minister at IITMAA Sangam 2026?

(a) The UPI Story (b) Cashless Nation: How UPI Changed Everything (c) Digital Rupee Rising (d) India Stack Unbound

Answer: (b) Cashless Nation: How UPI Changed Everything

178. India and the UAE are targeting bilateral trade of how much by 2032?

(a) USD 100 billion (b) USD 150 billion (c) USD 200 billion (d) USD 500 billion

Answer: (c) USD 200 billion

179. Who is the President of the New Development Bank, who participated in the 18th BRICS Summit in New Delhi?

(a) K.V. Kamath (b) Marcos Troyjo (c) Dilma Rousseff (d) Ngozi Okonjo-Iweala

Answer: (c) Dilma Rousseff

180. Who was appointed MD & CEO of IFFCO-TOKIO General Insurance, replacing Subrata Mondal?

(a) Tatsuya Fujimoto (b) Hiroshi Tanaka (c) Kenji Watanabe (d) Takeshi Sato

Answer: (a) Tatsuya Fujimoto

181. IFFCO-TOKIO General Insurance is a joint venture between IFFCO and Tokio Marine Group in what ratio?

(a) 74:26 (b) 51:49 (c) 50:50 (d) 60:40

Answer: (b) 51:49

182. Manish Kothari, who resigned after 31 years, was Group President and Head of Commercial Bank at which bank?

(a) HDFC Bank (b) Axis Bank (c) Kotak Mahindra Bank (d) IndusInd Bank

Answer: (c) Kotak Mahindra Bank

183. Who is the MD & CEO of Kotak Mahindra Bank?

(a) Uday Kotak (b) Ashok Vaswani (c) Sashidhar Jagdishan (d) Rajiv Anand

Answer: (b) Ashok Vaswani

184. IAS officer Saurabh Kumar was appointed Government Nominee Director on the board of which bank?

(a) Bank of India (b) Bank of Maharashtra (c) Central Bank of India (d) UCO Bank

Answer: (b) Bank of Maharashtra

185. Saurabh Kumar's appointment as Government Nominee Director was notified under which Act?

(a) Banking Regulation Act, 1949 (b) Banking Companies (Acquisition and Transfer of Undertakings) Act, 1970 (c) SBI Act, 1955 (d) Companies Act, 2013

Answer: (b) Banking Companies (Acquisition and Transfer of Undertakings) Act, 1970

186. Who has been appointed MD & CEO of Standard Chartered Capital Limited?

(a) Zarin Daruwala (b) Abhinav Trivedi (c) PD Singh (d) Sachin Shah

Answer: (b) Abhinav Trivedi

187. Who will take over as World Bank Group Chief Economist from 1 October 2026?

(a) Abhijit Banerjee (b) Esther Duflo (c) Michael Kremer (d) Paul Romer

Answer: (c) Michael Kremer

188. Michael Kremer succeeds whom as World Bank Chief Economist?

(a) Carmen Reinhart (b) Indermit Gill (c) Kaushik Basu (d) Pinelopi Goldberg

Answer: (b) Indermit Gill

189. Fintech BharatPe appointed Yugal Tiwari to which position?

(a) Chief Executive Officer (b) Chief Financial Officer (c) Chief Product and Marketing Officer (d) Chief Technology Officer

Answer: (c) Chief Product and Marketing Officer

190. What is the legal name of BharatPe?

(a) One97 Communications Ltd (b) Resilient Innovations Pvt Ltd (c) Mobikwik Systems Ltd (d) Dreamplug Technologies Pvt Ltd

Answer: (b) Resilient Innovations Pvt Ltd

191. Who has been given additional charge as Chairperson of the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Board of India (IBBI)?

(a) Ravi Mital (b) M.S. Sahoo (c) Jayanti Prasad (d) Sudhaker Shukla

Answer: (c) Jayanti Prasad

192. Which LIC Managing Director's voluntary retirement was approved by the government in September 2026?

(a) Dinesh Pant (b) Siddhartha Mohanty (c) R. Doraiswamy (d) Tablesh Pandey

Answer: (a) Dinesh Pant

193. CDSL appointed Kinjal Shah as its Chief Technology Officer. Whom did he succeed?

(a) Nehal Vora (b) Amit Mahajan (c) Ashish Chauhan (d) Mohit Mehta

Answer: (b) Amit Mahajan

194. Jammu and Kashmir Bank received the 'Best CSR Overall Practices' award at which event?

(a) 13th National CSR Leadership Congress, Bengaluru (b) India CSR Summit, New Delhi (c) FICCI CSR Awards, Mumbai (d) Global Fintech Fest, Mumbai

Answer: (a) 13th National CSR Leadership Congress, Bengaluru

195. Who is the MD & CEO of Jammu and Kashmir Bank?

(a) Baldev Prakash (b) Amitava Chatterjee (c) Rajeev Yadav (d) Shanti Lal Jain

Answer: (b) Amitava Chatterjee

196. B2B e-commerce firm Udaan acquired which Swiggy subsidiary for Rs 500 crore?

(a) Instamart (b) Dineout (c) LYNK Logistics (d) Scootsy

Answer: (c) LYNK Logistics

197. Novartis India acquired the Minipress brands in India from Pfizer for how much?

(a) Rs 500 crore (b) Rs 933 crore (c) Rs 1,250 crore (d) Rs 2,286 crore

Answer: (c) Rs 1,250 crore

198. Who is the Chairman of State Bank of India?

(a) Dinesh Kumar Khara (b) Challa Sreenivasulu Setty (c) Rajkiran Rai G (d) Ashwini Kumar Tewari

Answer: (b) Challa Sreenivasulu Setty

199. The India–New Zealand Free Trade Agreement is scheduled to enter into force on which date?

(a) 1 October 2026 (b) 20 October 2026 (c) 1 January 2027 (d) 1 April 2027

Answer: (b) 20 October 2026

200. At GFF 2026, which digital public infrastructure combination did RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra credit for India's financial inclusion success?

(a) JAM – Jan Dhan, Aadhaar, Mobile (b) BHIM–RuPay–IMPS (c) ONDC–OCEN–AA (d) DigiLocker–eSign–UMANG

Answer: (a) JAM – Jan Dhan, Aadhaar, Mobile

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